

Content calendars and batching

Week 4, Lecture 1 · Grow on X: From Zero to 10,000 Followers

Autumn 2026 · Solo creators

What we'll cover today

- **Why cadence beats peaks:** daily posting vs. sporadic excellence
- **Batching:** write once, schedule across the week
- **Post-mix:** the three-bucket model (evergreen, timely, personal)
- **Engagement-bait:** why it works short-term and costs you long-term

Why cadence beats peaks

Sporadic excellence is invisible

The algorithm rewards consistent signal, not occasional brilliance.

- A post that hits on Tuesday trains the system to show your work
- A gap of two weeks resets that signal close to zero
- Your audience's feed is a river: if you step away, you're gone

The question is not "what is my best post." It is "what can I post every day."

Daily posting is a skill, not a grind

Dickie Bush and Nicolas Cole: ship 30 posts in 30 days as training, not as the permanent pace.

The goal is to find out what you actually believe quickly enough to edit it.

- First 10 posts: find your voice
- Next 10: find your format
- Last 10: find your audience

(Basilio, Growth in Reverse, 2023)

Batching

The problem with writing one post per day

Paul Graham (2009) on the maker's schedule:

"A single meeting can blow a whole afternoon, by breaking it into two pieces each too small to do anything hard in."

Writing one post per day is that meeting. You switch into creative mode, write one thing, and switch back out.

Batching gives you the maker's block.

The hub-and-spoke model

Justin Welsh's system: one core piece (Saturday Solopreneur newsletter) becomes 10-20 short posts staggered over 4-6 weeks.

Saturday newsletter

- Hook post (week 1)
- Contrarian take (week 2)
- How-to thread (week 3)
- Personal story (week 4)
- Data point (week 5-6)

~4 hours/week total. (Basilio, Growth in Reverse, 2023)

What a batching session produces

One two-hour Sunday session can yield:

- 5-7 drafted posts (single post or thread opener)
- 1 thread outline
- 3-4 evergreen hooks from a longer piece

The daily 15-minute writing slot is for scheduling, not drafting.

The three-bucket post-mix

Evergreen posts

No expiry date. Useful on any day of any year.

Examples: frameworks, lessons learned, how-tos, first principles.

- Can be batched weeks in advance
- Compounding asset: still gets found six months later
- Should be the largest share of your calendar

Timely posts

Tied to a current event, trend, or news item in your niche.

- Short shelf life: if it lands 48 hours late, it lands flat
- Do NOT batch these in advance: write day-of
- Give you an in-the-room feeling that evergreen posts can't

Rule: timely posts go on a separate list, not in the batching block.

Personal posts

Your story, your opinion, your process, your failure.

- Hardest to batch because they require something to have happened
- Fix: keep a running list of observations throughout the week
- Batching block converts the list into posts, not events into posts

The personal bucket is what makes the other two worth reading.

A sample post-mix

Conservative (new account)

- 60% evergreen
- 20% timely
- 20% personal

Engaged (growing account)

- 40% evergreen
- 25% timely
- 35% personal

Adjust based on what your audience responds to. Check monthly.

The engagement-bait trap

What engagement-bait looks like

- "Retweet if you agree / like if you disagree"
- "Drop a 1 if you want the full thread"
- Manufactured outrage on off-niche topics
- Polls with no editorial position

These work. They spike impressions and follower counts.

Why engagement-bait destroys long-term trust

The followers bait attracts are not your audience: they are bait followers.

- Lower reply rate on real posts
- Weaker social proof for new visitors
- Dilutes your niche signal in the algorithm

Tim Denning (2024): sustainability comes from work that creates flow, not from optimization theater.

The test for any post

Before you publish: "Does this add something to the reader's day, or does it just ask for a reaction?"

Posts that ask for a reaction without adding value are overhead, not assets.

Take-aways

1. Cadence compounds. Daily posting at 70% quality beats sporadic posting at 100%.
2. Batching is a maker's block. Write in one session, schedule across the week.
3. Use three buckets: evergreen (batch weeks ahead), timely (write day-of), personal (convert your observation log).
4. Engagement-bait spikes metrics and corrodes trust. The test: adds something vs. asks for a reaction.

"He's staggering his content out across 4-6 weeks. This allows him to continue plugging that same issue of the newsletter weeks later."

Chenell Basilio, Growth in Reverse (2023), on Justin Welsh

What's next

- **Section (this week):** build your weekly system on paper
- **Reading:** Week 4 reading, Building a sustainable weekly system
- **Lecture 2:** Collaboration and the network

HW 3 out this week: run your system for two weeks.

Capstone out this week: 90-day playbook.